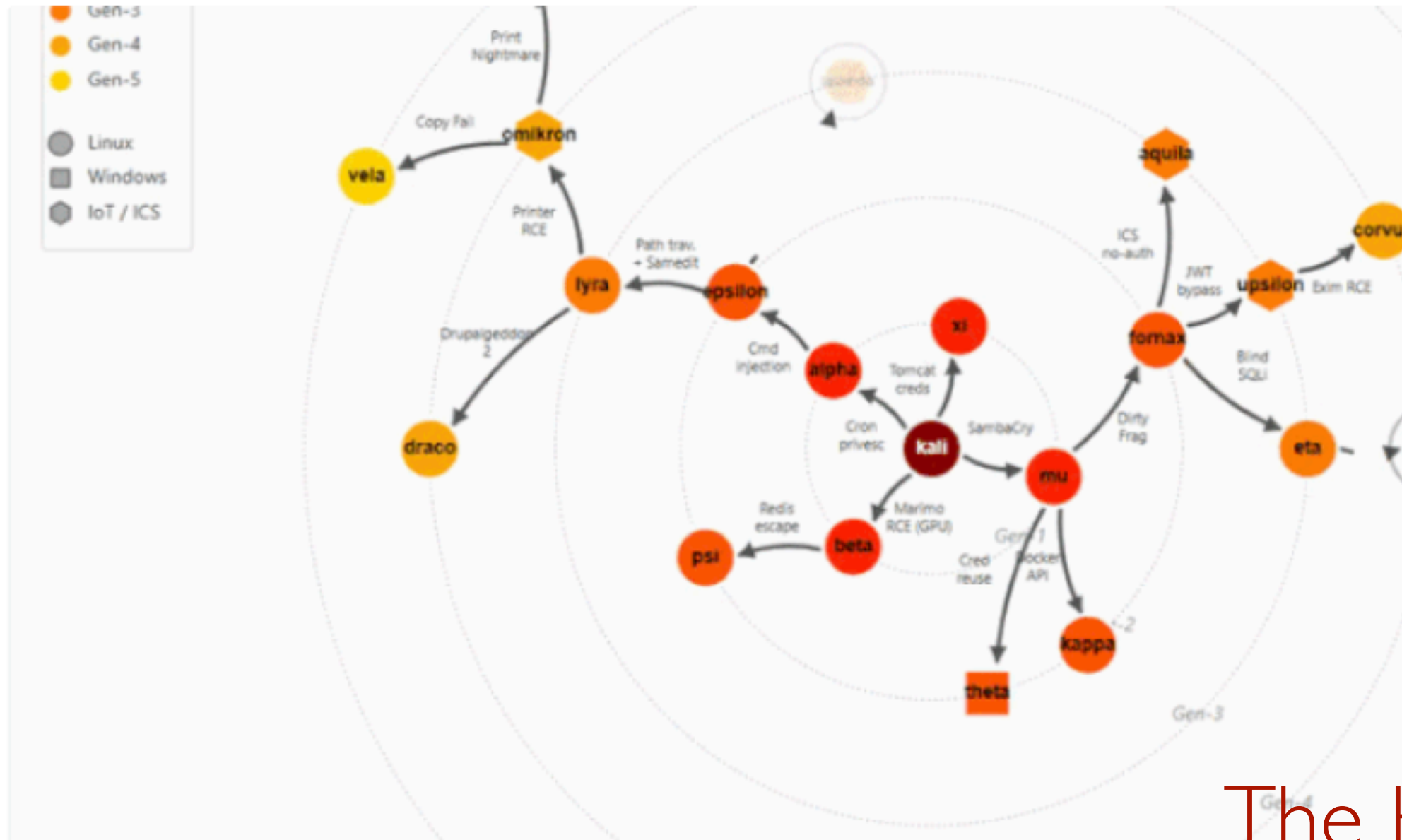


Researchers Build Self-Replicating AI Worm That Operates Entirely on Local, Open-Weight Models

Swati Khandelwal Jun 09, 2026



The Hacker News

University of Toronto researchers have built and tested a proof-of-concept AI-driven computer worm that uses a locally hosted open-weight large language model to reason its way through a network, generate tailored attack strategies for each target it encounters, and replicate itself, all without human intervention and without touching a commercial AI service.

June 2026

OpenAI Says Reward Hacking Drove AI Agents to Exploit Zero-Days and Breach Hugging Face

👤 Ravie Lakshmanan 📅 Aug 27, 2026



The Hacker News

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